FIGHTER SUBCLASS · D&D 2024

Nailmaster

A warrior who plants their feet, gathers their strength, and unleashes devastating charged strikes taught by one of three legendary brothers.

V0.1 PLAYTEST FIGHTER LEVELS 3–18 INSPIRED BY HOLLOW KNIGHT

Long ago, the Great Nailsage trained three brothers, Oro, Mato, and Sheo, and each mastered one Nail Art: the lunging Dash Slash, the whirling Cyclone Slash, and the crushing Great Slash. The brothers went their separate ways; one became a hermit, one a cheerful teacher, and one put down his nail for a painter's brush. Their students still carry the Arts. A Nailmaster doesn't fight with speed or tricks. They stand their ground, draw in their strength, and strike with everything at once.

FIGHTER LEVEL	FEATURES
3rd	Nail Arts, Teacher's Lesson, Nailsmith's Work (Sharpened Nail)
7th	Second Art, Channelled Nail
10th	Third Art, Coiled Nail, Unmoving Stance
15th	Nailmaster's Pride, Pure Nail
18th	Nailsage's Glory

LEVEL 3

Nail Arts

If you haven't moved yet this turn, you can make your first attack with your nail a Nail Art you know. When you do, your Speed becomes 0 until the end of the turn. Speed 0 stops walking and the Dash action, but not teleportation or forced movement.

Nail Arts use Art Dice, which are d8s. Your number of Art Dice is set by Nailsmith's Work.

NAIL ART	EFFECT
Great Slash	If the attack hits, it deals extra damage equal to all your Art Dice.
Dash Slash	Before the attack, move up to 20 feet in a straight line without provoking Opportunity Attacks. This movement is part of the Art. If the attack hits, it deals one extra Art Die of damage.
Cyclone Slash	Instead of one attack, make a separate attack against each creature of your choice within your reach.

LEVEL 3

Teacher's Lesson

Choose the brother who trained you. You learn his Nail Art and gain his lesson.

TEACHER	NAIL ART	LESSON
Oro	Dash Slash	Your Speed increases by 10 feet, and Dash Slash moves you up to 30 feet.
Mato	Cyclone Slash	When Cyclone Slash hits two or more creatures, you gain Temporary Hit Points equal to your Fighter level.
Sheo	Great Slash	Great Slash scores a Critical Hit on a roll of 19 or 20. You gain proficiency with Painter's Supplies, and if you spend at least 1 hour of a Long Rest painting, you gain Heroic Inspiration when it ends.

LEVEL 3

Nailsmith's Work

Choose one melee weapon as your nail; only your nail can perform Nail Arts. It counts as magical for overcoming Resistance. If you lose it, you can bond with a new weapon during a Long Rest. As you gain levels, your nail is reforged:

FIGHTER LEVEL	NAIL	ART DICE
3rd	Sharpened Nail	1d8
7th	Channelled Nail	2d8
10th	Coiled Nail	3d8
15th	Pure Nail	4d8

LEVEL 7

Second Art

You learn a second Nail Art of your choice.

LEVEL 10

Third Art

You learn the remaining Nail Art.

LEVEL 10

Unmoving Stance

While you haven't moved this turn, or while your Speed is 0 from a Nail Art, you have Advantage on saving throws against having the Prone condition or being moved against your will.

LEVEL 15

Nailmaster's Pride

When you perform a Nail Art, you can make another attack that turn a different Nail Art. For example, you might Dash Slash into a crowd, then Cyclone Slash.

LEVEL 18

Nailsage's Glory

You have learned what the Great Nailsage knew. Nail Arts no longer require you to be still and no longer reduce your Speed, and your Art Dice become d10s.

DESIGNER NOTES

- **Commit to the strike.** Nail Arts are free and unlimited, but you can't move before one and you're rooted after it. Dash Slash is the exception: it moves as part of the Art, then you stop where you land.
- **The teacher shapes the build.** Oro is mobile, Mato fights crowds, and Sheo hits one target very hard. By level 10 every Nailmaster knows all three Arts.
- **Damage check.** Sneak Attack reaches 8d6 at level 15; a Great Slash at 4d8, once per turn and only while rooted, sits below it even with three Fighter attacks.
- **Story hook.** Each Nailsmith upgrade can be tied to a quest for pale ore instead of a level.
- Is Cyclone Slash too strong against hordes, since it's unlimited?
- Should Mato's Temporary Hit Points scale less steeply?
- Is Nailmaster's Pride's second Art per turn too much with Pure Nail's 4d8?

V0.1 PLAYTEST: FIRST PUBLIC RELEASE

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